

Tobias Treppmann

Product designer who runs the product too — specs, tickets, customer calls, and prototypes engineering ships from

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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PORTFOLIO

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA

2022 – 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland

2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organisations.

PROFILE

I've spent fifteen years in B2B software, and the parts I do best are the parts nobody assigns — writing the spec, running the board, sitting on the customer call. I prototype in real code against real APIs, and engineering ships from it. The last year went into AI that runs in production rather than AI that demos.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV; engineering is an external agency) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- Prototypes in real code, and the agency ships from them — web first, then Android, running against real APIs rather than clickable mockups. Around 70% of the AI-generated code lands. Iteration went from days to hours. The handoff crosses a company boundary and still holds.
- I write the specs and run the board — the tickets engineering works from are mine to write and prioritise, and I check the built feature in production and beta rather than calling it done at handoff.
- AI support copilot, live in production — assistive drafting for viewer letters, emails and social messages, following the handbook's wording, formatting and standard phrases. Restricted topics are enforced in the output. The draft is suppressed entirely when the input is not a viewer enquiry, and every send decision stays human. Rolled out fully optional.
- AI fundraising ecosystem, built solo end to end — analysis, prompt architecture, prototype, then a production Claude skill generating follow-up content across in-app, web and video.
- Design system as an API — DTCG tokens, Style Dictionary, multi-platform sync. Built without a platform team, so that consistency holds structurally instead of by asking people.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — ~50 people, DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Designer and product manager at once — product management for the main platform plus all product design. I wrote the specs, ran the ticket board engineering worked from, and was the main customer-facing contact for the launch parish throughout.
- Booking module — the decision I defended through the build — inherited a €20k client-funded booking project scoped internally as a standalone add-on module and reframed it into a platform capability, choosing deep platform integration over the faster standalone module and holding that line to delivery. 70% coordination-time reduction and 90% acceptance at the launch customer, where funerals had to be bookable across 20+ cemeteries. It then shipped to every customer as a general booking capability — room rentals, baptisms, weddings.
- Two designers, no design organisation above us — 1 direct report, and the bar was mine to set and defend.
- AI alt-text in production — shipped for EU accessibility compliance under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law, across six countries.
- Engineering owned the implementation — the web client in React and the mobile app in React Native were written by the engineers on the team, not by me. Design in Figma, build in code, daily contact across the two-month build.

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Prompt-to-database onboarding, with the CEO and technical co-founder (freelance, summer 2025) — the AI-generated schema renders into the real data-model editor, not a chat preview, so people can see and correct what the model produced. It became the basis for the public AI beta.
- Research at a scale a team cannot read — Claude over thousands of forum posts for sentiment, pain points and feature requests, with Dovetail as the shared insight repository. Above a few hundred data points that analysis happens or it does not happen at all; below it, I read the responses, because nuance is the first thing a summariser drops.
- Senior Leadership Team, 5 direct reports including a design lead — and shared design-system governance established across 4 designers and engineering.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Service-to-product transformation — partnered with the executive team to productise the service organisation. Case-by-case support became a standard catalogue.
- Methodology transfer — ran design-thinking training for executive leadership and service teams.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Five years of data-dense B2B desktop interfaces — big-data pivot tables, column charts, aggregated JSON views, result cards and filter logic. The hardest of them was the query-builder preview, where the result you see is a sample and the interface has to be honest about that without becoming unreadable.
- Research inside institutions that make users hard to reach — pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to get to analysts working inside banks and insurers. The platform operated under HIPAA compliance among other frameworks.
- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years — two UX designers reporting to me inside a four-person design org, reporting to the VP Design. A six-hour gap, held together by cross-timezone collaboration processes I established.
- Design system, co-built — UX defined component behaviour and specs. UI executed the visual system.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Düsseldorf, Germany

E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalia Werkzeugcompany* · 1999 · Hagen, Germany

SKILLS

Product Ownership Without a PM

Writing the spec · Running the ticket board engineering works from · Customer calls and discovery as the main contact · Deciding what ships · Defending a scope decision through the build · Product management for a platform alongside all of its design

Prototyping and Engineering Proximity

Prototypes in real code against real APIs · Agentic engineering with Claude Code · Engineering shipping from prototype code across a company boundary · Verifying features in production and beta · HTML · CSS · TypeScript · SwiftUI · Kotlin · React

Dense and Data-Heavy Interfaces

Big-data pivot tables · Column charts · Aggregated JSON views · Result cards · Filter logic · Query-builder previews and sample-based uncertainty · Five years of B2B SaaS desktop for banks and insurers

AI in Production

Customer-support copilot live in production · AI fundraising ecosystem built solo end to end · Prompt architecture and prompt-to-database interaction patterns · Human-in-the-loop by design: escalation as a first-class output, the send decision stays human · Claude skills that let other people do the work without me

Design Systems and Tooling

Design system as an API · DTCG tokens · Style Dictionary · Storybook · Figma Variables · Multi-platform sync · Shared design-system governance across designers and engineering

Regulated Environments and Markets

GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law across six countries · EU accessibility compliance shipped · HIPAA-compliant analytics platform · Multi-country product across DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH and DACH / UK / US · German native, English C2 · Berlin, CET